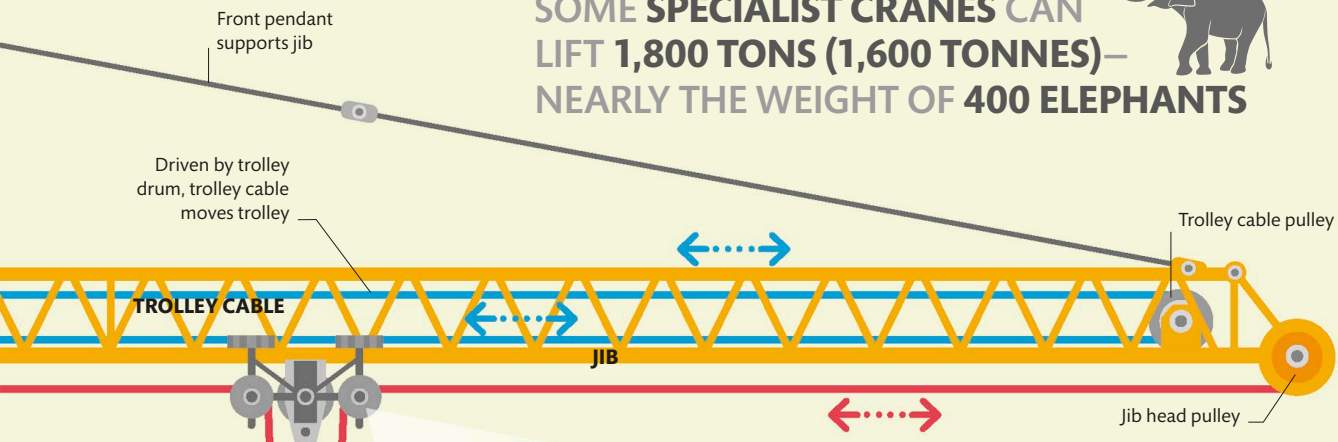
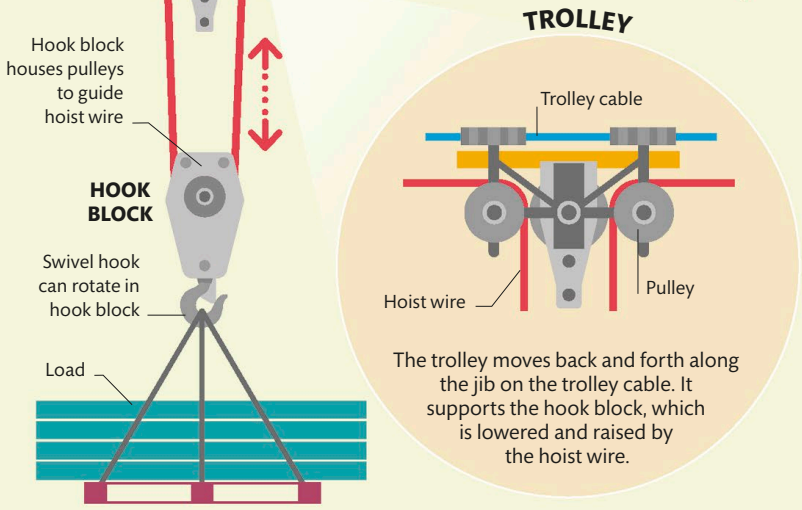
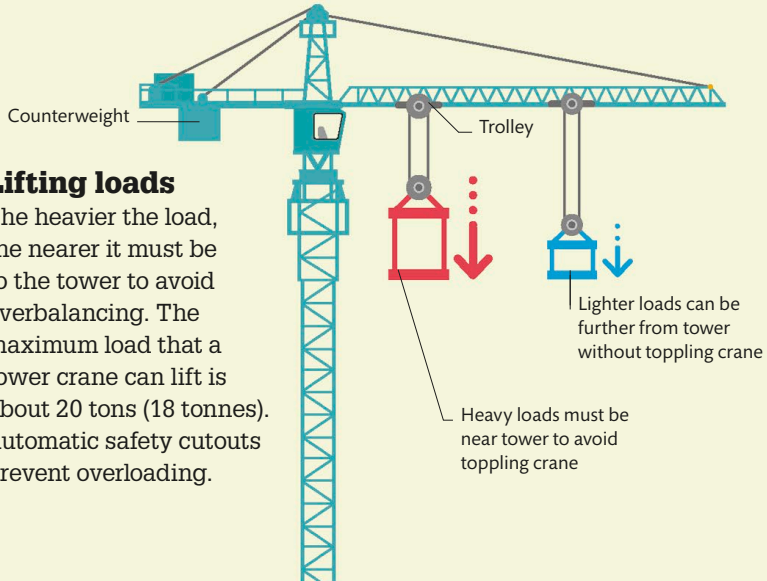
SOME **SPECIALIST CRANES** CAN LIFT **1,800 TONS (1,600 TONNES)**– NEARLY THE WEIGHT OF **400 ELEPHANTS**







Lifting loads

The heavier the load, the nearer it must be to the tower to avoid overbalancing. The maximum load that a tower crane can lift is about 20 tons (18 tonnes). Automatic safety cutouts prevent overloading.

Types of cranes

Most land-based cranes fall into four main types: tower cranes, including cantilever cranes; overhead cranes, such as gantry cranes; level-luffing cranes; and mobile cranes, which often use hydraulics for lifting loads.



Mobile crane
A mobile crane is mounted on a truck chassis with the crane mounted on a turntable. The crane is powered by hydraulics.



Level-luffing crane
In this crane, the hook stays at the same level while the jib moves up and down, moving the hook inward and outward.



Gantry crane
This type of crane is on a fixed structure straddling an object or workspace. Gantry cranes are often used in shipyards or container depots.



Cantilever crane
Cantilever cranes are the low-level forerunners of tower cranes. They have a steel tower with a rotating, counterbalanced jib.